

Google launches 'Made in India' programme to showcase local developers

Google has launched its own 'Made in India' initiative. The new development is designed to promote Indian developers, giving them a chance to feature their work on the Play Store in a special section.



"At Google Play, we are committed to helping Indian developers of all levels seize this opportunity and build successful, locally relevant businesses," said Purnima Kochikar, director of business development for games and applications, Google Play.

Google highlights that more than 70 per cent of Internet users in India enter the Web primarily using smartphones. This growth in smartphone usage has prompted the company to encourage domestic developers to build more apps and games. More content could pave the way for the Android maker to strengthen its presence in India and around the globe.

Revealing some numbers, Google underlines that Indian users on Android install more than a billion apps every month from Google Play, and this number is growing by 150 per cent each year. The 'Made in India' initiative was launched as a part of the App Excellence Summit that was recently hosted in Bengaluru. Google also showcased success stories from developers including Dailyhunt, Healthifyme, RailYatri and UrbanClap that are all natively building apps and services for the Android platform. Skill-building consultation sessions and demonstration booths were available at the venue for developers.

Indian developers who want to participate in the 'Made in India' programme by Google need to fill in a self-nomination form. The apps need to be based on Google's 'Build for Billions' guidelines that were launched last year.

PiCluster v2.0 brings better container management for Docker deployments

Linux Toys has announced PiCluster 2.0. The new version of the open source container management tool is written in Node.js and is designed to deliver an upgraded experience through cleaner CSS and JQuery dialog windows.



PiCluster 2.0 brings automatic container failover to different hosts. It fixes reported errors in npm build dependency as well as utilises enhancements on the CSS front to deliver a fresh look to the tool's Web console.

Additionally, users can deploy container management without Internet access by using the Web server to deliver required libraries.

On booting up PiCluster 2.0, you'll be welcomed with a new screen. The open source community has also contributed a lot of features to the latest PiCluster

Angular 5 is out, with a focus on progressive Web apps

Google has released the next major version of its JavaScript framework, AngularJS. This latest version, Angular 5, is the second major update in 2017.

While the initial release is a beta build of Angular 5, the search giant is clearly aiming to introduce major support for Google-driven progressive Web apps with the latest development. The new version includes a build optimiser that helps to reduce the code of progressive apps designed through the framework.

Google is working hard at simplifying the effort that goes into building progressive Web apps. The purpose of this new innovation is to improve the experience for users accessing services through their mobile devices.



In addition to its progressive Web app focus, Google is integrating Material Design components into Angular 5. The design components in Angular 5 are now compatible with server-side rendering.

Google is not the sole enabler to have enhanced browser-based apps. Mozilla is also set to offer a native-like experience on its Firefox browser by bringing progressive Web apps to the front. The team behind PWAs (progressive Web apps) is working towards making these as the technology that everyone can use.

The release cycle of Angular has been quite aggressive. Google plans to release the next major version, slated as Angular 6, sometime in March or April next year. Meanwhile, the theme for Angular 5 is 'Easier, smaller, faster'.